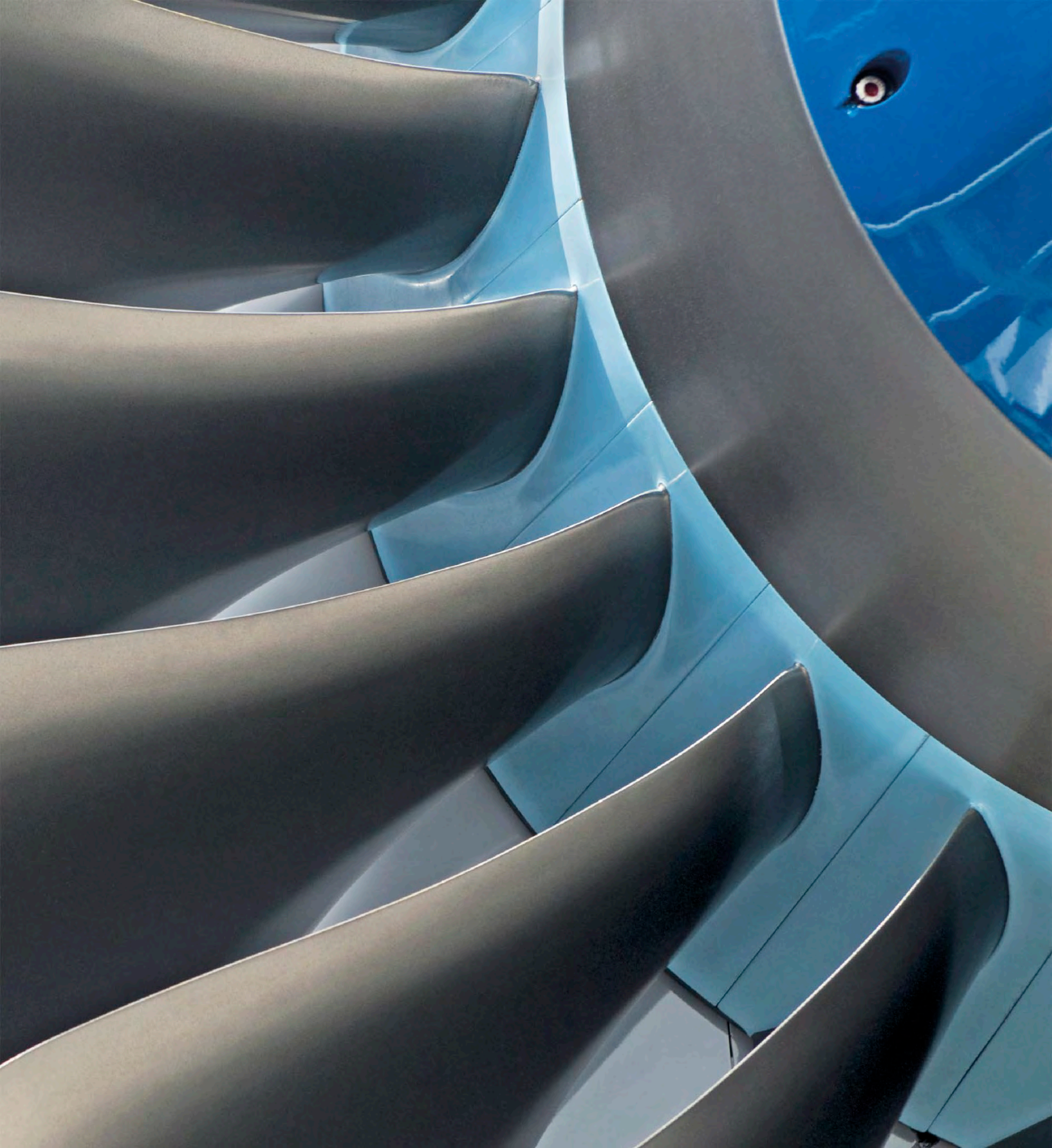




Aluminium is what makes high-speed, long-range air travel possible. Easily moulded, it is one-quarter the weight of steel, and it never rusts. Steel is stronger, but a plane made from it would be too heavy to fly. Instead aluminium is mixed with titanium and steel to produce tough yet lightweight alloys, which are used in the engines

and bodies of jet aircraft. There is almost twice as much aluminium in Earth's rock as there is iron. However, purifying aluminium takes a lot of energy. Once pure, though, it can be recycled over and over again. So, one day these engine blades might transform into a fizzy drink can.